

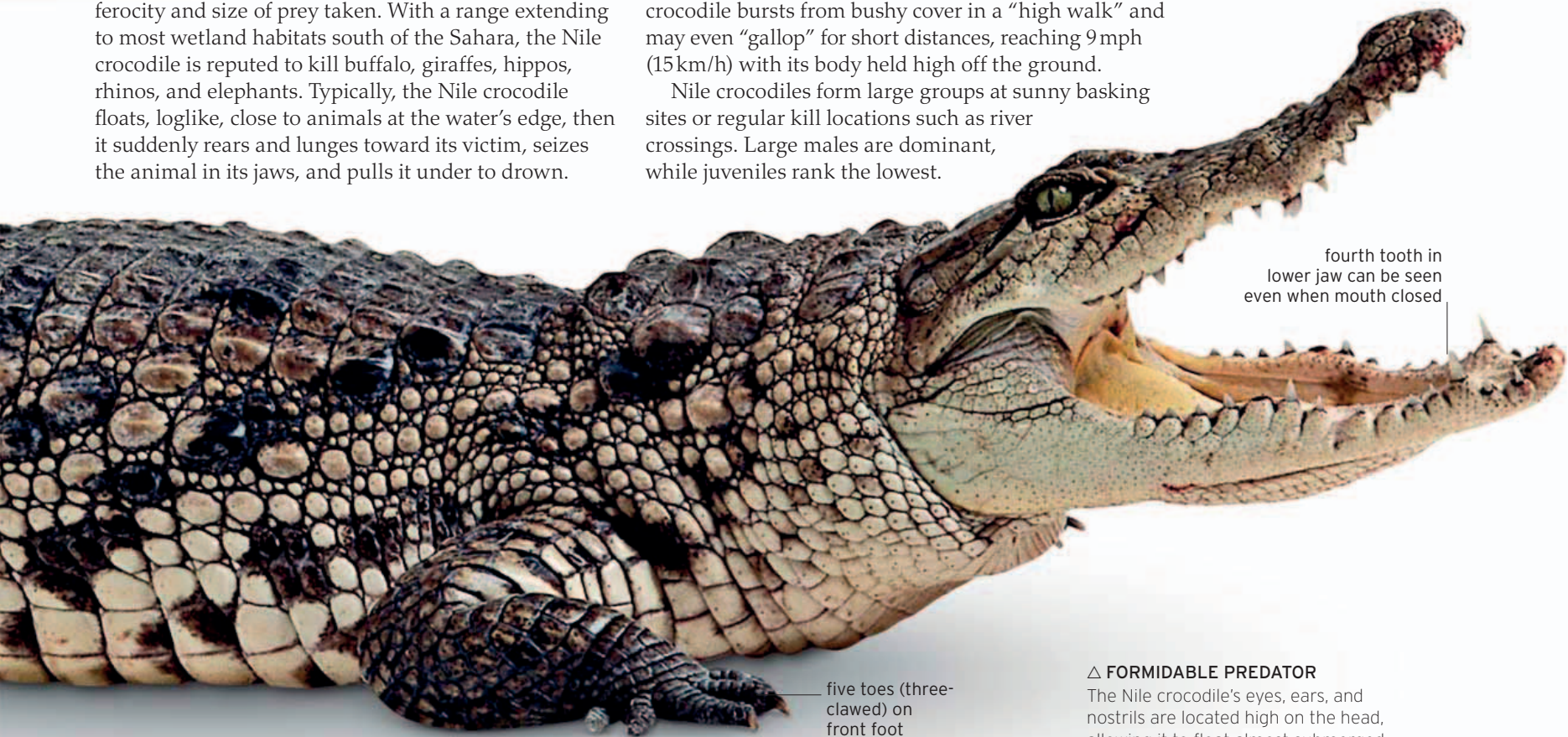
# Nile crocodile

## *Crocodylus niloticus*

Among reptiles, only the saltwater crocodile (*C. porosus*) exceeds the Nile crocodile in bulk, but perhaps not in ferocity and size of prey taken. With a range extending to most wetland habitats south of the Sahara, the Nile crocodile is reputed to kill buffalo, giraffes, hippos, rhinos, and elephants. Typically, the Nile crocodile floats, loglike, close to animals at the water's edge, then it suddenly rears and lunges toward its victim, seizes the animal in its jaws, and pulls it under to drown.

It may spin in a "death roll" to dismember a struggling animal or large carcass. Land attacks also occur. The crocodile bursts from bushy cover in a "high walk" and may even "gallop" for short distances, reaching 9 mph (15 km/h) with its body held high off the ground.

Nile crocodiles form large groups at sunny basking sites or regular kill locations such as river crossings. Large males are dominant, while juveniles rank the lowest.



fourth tooth in lower jaw can be seen even when mouth closed

five toes (three-clawed) on front foot

### △ FORMIDABLE PREDATOR

The Nile crocodile's eyes, ears, and nostrils are located high on the head, allowing it to float almost submerged in water, yet see, hear, and breathe.

# Zebra mbuna

## *Maylandia zebra*

This striped fish grazes on the thick algal mats that grow in the shallower areas in Lake Malawi. It feeds with its head held perpendicular to the rock, scraping away with its teeth to scoop up the algae and any tiny animals that live in it. Like many species of lake cichlid, the zebra mbuna is a mouth brooder, with the female carrying her eggs in her mouth for three weeks. She is unable to feed during this time, and once the fry have hatched, she will spit them out.

- ↔ 4 in (10 cm)
- 🏠 Not known
- ⊗ Locally common
- 🌿 Algae, zooplankton
- 🏠 🌿 🌊



Africa  
(Lake Malawi)



### △ FISH OF MANY COLORS

Light and dark male morphs are found in different parts of the lake. Females also vary in color, from pale orange to dark brown, but these variations are not restricted by location.